

TV for 99 cents

Apple is developing a new Apple TV that will feature TV shows at just 99 cents

Valve releases free games

Valve recently released an updated version of the old Unreal Tournament mod, Alien Swarm, for free along with source code

Hard drive queries

- My PC configuration is as follows
- Intel Core 2 Duo E8400 3.0 GHz
 - Asus P5QC Mobo
 - Corsair 2x2Gb DDR3 1333 RAM
 - Sapphire 4670HD 1GB DDR3 graphics card
 - Seagate ST3500418AS 500GB HDD (16 MB cache) + Western Digital WD3200AAJS HDD 320GB HDD
 - OS: Vista Ultimate x64
1. My doubt is which HDD should I install my OS? Is there any performance variation by doing this?
 2. How much space should I allocate for installing Vista? Will there be any performance variations by allocating 200 GB for all my software and OS?
- I have already replaced my Seagate HDD twice (S.M.A.R.T test failed - I read that it's because of power problems. Do I need to check my SMPS and motherboard?)

Vipin

Both the drives have more or less the same performance. It shouldn't matter. I would keep at least 40 - 50 GB for the OS drive, at least, along with installed essential applications (browsers, instant messengers, download managers, email clients, office suites, etc.). Games and other media can go on other partitions. SMART errors are mainly due to drive problems.

New laptop and its errors

- I bought a Sony VAIO laptop last month. It's configuration is as follows:
- Intel core i3-330M processor 2.13 GHz
 - Windows 7 home premium (64 bit)
 - Hard Disk Drive 500 GB
 - 4 GB RAM
 - ATI Radeon 5650 1 GB

The problem is that it pops up a dialog box. Another problem is that whenever I shut down my laptop, it shows an error "Background programs is running, do you want to force shut down or cancel?". How do I solve this problem?

I have been regular reader of Digit, it helps me a lot in learning tech activities, all my friends call me tech guru. I am really thankful to ThinkDigit.

Chandrashekar Sirimala

The dialog box could be due to cor-

rupted software, bad drivers or even a worm or virus. It's difficult to pinpoint what the problem might be.

If you are running several applications in the background while shutting down the PC, it's common to see the error where Windows asks you to force shut. Ideally, turn off all background applications before starting the shutdown process.

BSODs while gaming

I am Akshansh Vatsa, a regular reader of yours you are truly great. I have a Compaq Presario SG3350IL with the following configuration

- Compaq 7540 plug and play CRT 17-inch monitor
- Intel Core 2 Duo processor
- 1GB DDR2 RAM

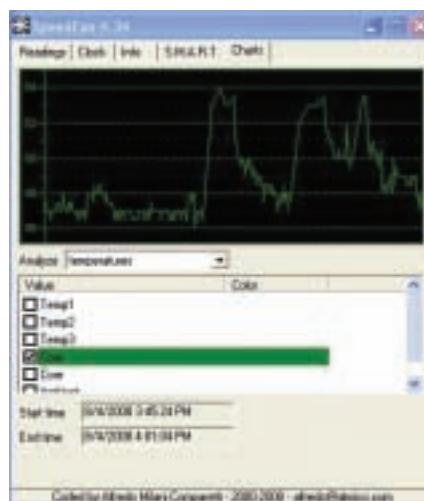
My problem is whenever I play *Counter Strike: Condition Zero* or *Half-Life*, my system hangs completely and after 2 to 3 seconds it shows a BLUE SCREEN OF DEATH. Please give me a solution to my problem.

Akshansh Vatsa

The game probably crashes due to a faulty card or display drivers. Download and install the latest version of display drivers for your card. That should fix the problem. Also, try using Speedfan to check if your card or processor is overheating.

Files not copied

A few days back, I copied some files to my 500 GB WD portable hard drive using



Graph showing BSOD's during games

Linux. But when I tried to rename them or copy them, I was unable to do so. I could somehow rename the folder containing those files. A popup error message appears saying that the system was unable to find the files. When I go to properties of those files, it shows the size of those files to be 0 bytes.

Raj Chahal

We've seen similar problems while copying files using a Linux distribution from one drive to an external USB flash or hard drive. In your case, there is no way to access the data because it wasn't written properly in the first place. You should go back to the PC and copy the data again.

Both CD and DVD writers not working

I am a computer shop owner for the past ten years and a reader of Digit for the past seven years. It helps me a lot to troubleshoot several hardware and software related problems. But now, I'm facing a problem with my CD/DVD drives. They don't work at all.

Details:

- Motherboard: Intel 810 Frontech
- CPU Intel 600 MHz Celeron
- 512MB SD RAM
- Hard Disk 40 GB PATA Seagate Barracuda
- LG CD-R / LG DVD-RW
- OS Windows XP Home Edition
- Antivirus Quick Heal Plus 2009 which is updated regularly

My system was working very well in the beginning. I use it only for office purpose and net surfing. Recently, my CD and DVD drive had faced problems and they don't work. They are detected though the BIOS, but in My Computer, there is no sign of a disk drive. I have formatted the C partition and reinstalled the OS, and the system shows the disk drives.

Please help me solving the problem so that I can use CD/DVD Drives again. While scanning with Quick Heal the following message comes C:\windows\system32\gff6.exe detected and quarantined. Please reply as early as possible.

Asit Sarkar

DVD and CD drives are very unreliable and we've seen many of them failing